



Sunday School Department • Proclaiming God's Word World Wide

SUNDAY SCHOOL MANUAL

HEARING AND DOING THE WORD

Memory Verse: James 1:22

Text: James 1:22–25; James 2:12; Deut. 4:1–2, 6

Sunday, 9th August 2026



INTRODUCTION

Many believers hear the word of God regularly through sermons, teachings, and personal study. However, hearing alone does not bring transformation; believing, obeying, and doing the word bring results, and these results make us children of God and disciples. (*John 8:30–31*)

Hearing the word is the entry point to faith and spiritual growth, while doing the word means obedience, practising the word, living by the word, and acting on the word of God. (*Luke 11:27–28; John 14:21*)

IMPORTANCE OF HEARING AND DOING THE WORD

- 1. It builds our faith** — When we hear God's word, our faith in Him becomes stronger. (*Rom. 10:17*)
- 2. It builds life or gives life** (*Prov. 4:22; John 6:63*)
- 3. It gives direction (guides our life)** — It gives us direction when we do not know what decision to make. (*Psalms 119:105*)
- 4. It corrects and teaches us** — It teaches us the right way to live and also to recognise wrong actions and attitudes. (*2 Tim. 3:16*)
- 5. It helps us grow spiritually** — Regularly hearing and doing God's word helps us mature in our relationship with Him. (*1 Pet. 1:2*)
- 6. It prepares us to obey God** — Hearing the word should lead to action (obeying and doing). (*James 1:22*)

EXAMPLES OF THOSE WHO OBEYED AND ACTED ON THE WORD

1. Abraham

(*Gen. 12:1–14*)

He obeyed God; he was blessed and became a blessing to others.

2. Peter

(*Luke 5:4–6*)

He listened to the word of Jesus and acted on it, which brought abundant gain or blessing to him and those with him.

EXAMPLES OF PEOPLE WHO HEARD BUT DID NOT OBEY

1. King Saul

(*1 Sam. 15:1–22*)

King Saul heard the word of God but refused to fully obey His word, and he was rejected as king. **"Partial obedience is disobedience"** (*1 Sam. 15:22*).

2. The Foolish Builder

(*Matt. 7:26–27*)

The passage describes everyone who hears the word and does it not as a foolish man who built upon the sand. When a problem comes, it will destroy the house, and great was the fall of it.

3. Lot's Wife



(*Gen. 19:17, 26*)

Lot's wife disobeyed by looking back toward Sodom in an act of disobedience, and it brought destruction upon her.

4. Rich Young Ruler

(*Mark 10:17–22*)

The rich young ruler could not inherit eternal life because he could not obey Jesus' saying because of the great possessions he had.

DANGERS OF HEARING AND NOT DOING THE WORD

1. It brings God's rejection (*1 Sam. 15:24–26; Ezek. 33:33*)
2. It brings destruction (*Gen. 19:26 (Lot's wife)*)
3. It causes lack of spiritual growth (*Matt. 7:26–27*)
4. Self-deception (*Ezek. 33:30–32; James 1:22b*)

ADVANTAGES OF DOING THE WORD

- a. Fruitful Christian life (*John 15:7–8*)
- b. Blessings of God (*James 1:25*)
- c. Spiritual liberation (*John 8:31–32*)
- d. Meaningful life (stable) (*Matt. 7:24–25*)

SUMMARY

Obedience proves genuine faith in what we have heard in God's word. If we do not believe and obey what we hear, we cannot exercise faith in it. (*Rom. 10:17*)

CONCLUSION

(*James 1:22*) — Be ye doers of the word and not hearers only.

Memory Verse: *"But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves."*

— James 1:22 (KJV)